

BITS PILANI, DUBAI CAMPUS
Dubai International Academic City, U.A.E.
Semester II 2022
Quiz (CLOSED BOOK)

Course No: GS F 211 **Course Title: Modern Political Concepts**
Date: 15 Mar 2022 **Time: 10 mins** **Maximum Marks: 10** **Weightage: 10**

Name :..... **ID No.....**

Please choose most appropriate answer. Select only one answer.

Q 1. Books and Pens are most powerful weapons of the women. Which of the following Feminist has made this statement

- a) Marry Wollstonecraft
- b) Kate Millet
- c) Malala Yusufzai
- d) Karl Marx

Q2. Which of the following statement most appropriately convey the meaning of “Collectivization of Production” ?

- a) The state controls all private property and produces goods to collect revenue and the revenue is used to buy arm to make the state strong.
- b) The state takes over major production units and produces goods to collect revenue and the revenue is redistributed to the people through various schemes.
- c) State does not allow the people to produce goods and produces all goods to guarantee employment to all the people within the state.
- d) Since private players do not pay tax, the state takes control of all private production and generates revenue.

Q3. Which of the following form of capitalism believes in hire and fire of the workers and lower tax on the profit?

- a) Crony Capitalism
- b) Free Market Capitalism
- c) Advanced Capitalism
- d) None of the above.

Q 4. “Happy Women’s day to those women who put their legs on the ground instead of applying the brake to stop their scooties. #break the bias.”

The above statement is:

- a) Congratulatory message on women's day by a male counterpart to their female counterparts.
- b) Is a feminist statement given on the day of International Women's Day.
- c) It is a misogynist statement
- d) All of the above.

Q 5. The worst illiterate is the political illiterate. Which of the following statement truly conveys the essence of this statement?

- a) Those who do not know to read and write are political illiterate.
- b) Who do not study the politics are the political illiterate?
- c) Those who do not read newspapers or watch News debates on the TV are political illiterate
- d) Those who do not know how political decisions impact their lives are political illiterate.

Q 6. The essence of the statement made by various political philosophers are listed below. Please find the Correct match.

Political Philosophers

statement

- | | |
|--------------------|--|
| A. Karl Marx | 1. Industrial societies subdue argument and debate |
| B. Bismarck | 2. From each according to his ability, to each according to his need |
| C. Kate Millet | 3. Female population is controlled by male population. |
| D. Herbert Marcues | 4. Politics is Art of Government |

Now fill in the blanks with the correct match

A....., B..... C..... D..... (Ex: A..1)

Q7. Which of the following concepts highlight the link between female subordination and the capitalist mode of production?

- a) Socialism
- b) Marxism
- c) Capitalism
- d) Feminism

Q 8. A person in his speech argues that all the employment contracts and wages in the contractual jobs should be based on the consent of employees and employers. Identify his political orientation; He/she is

- a) Feminist
- b) Liberalist
- c) Socialist
- d) Marxist/communist

Q 9. A country where the governments has withdrawn from the production and no more has any stake of the State in the companies can be defined as

- a) Advanced Capitalism
- b) Unrestrained Capitalism
- c) Reformed Feminism
- d) Crony Capitalism

Q 10. The idea of Universal Basic Income has been drawn from which of the following political philosopher's idea?

- a) Karl Marx
- b) Herbert Marcues
- c) Thomas Paine
- d) Vladimir Lenin

BITS PILANI, DUBAI CAMPUS
Dubai International Academic City, U.A.E.
Semester II 2022
Mid-Sem Exam (CLOSED BOOK)

Course No: GS F 211 **Course Title: Modern Political Concepts**
Date: 15 Mar 2022 **Time: 90 mins** **Maximum Marks: 30** **Weightage: 30**

Q 1. Define the Concept of Feminism. Comparatively analyse the approaches of Liberal Feminism and Radical feminism to achieve gender equality.

Q 2. Explain at least five key features of Liberalism.

Q 3. The worst illiterate is political illiterate. Who made this statement? What does he mean when he uses the term “political illiterate?” Please explain this term based on the discussion in the class.

Q4. To end the “grave evils” of capitalism, a political philosopher suggested to adopt a “planned economy.” Name the political philosopher who made this statement. Then explain what he means by a “planned economy” and how can it eliminate the grave evils of capitalism.

**Q5. How Keynes and Hayek differ on the governments'/states' intervention in the economy?
Please explain their key points and the points on which they differ.**

**BITS PILANI, DUBAI CAMPUS
Dubai International Academic City, U.A.E.
Semester II 2022
Compre Exam Quiz (CLOSED BOOK)**

**Course No: GS F211 Course Title: Modern Political Concepts
Date: 02 June 2022 Time: 10 mins Maximum Marks: 10 Weightage: 10**

Answer Key (MCQ)

Part I

Note: Please select the most appropriate answer

- 1) The Universal Basic Income- (providing unconditional income as an entitlement to the people) was launched **in a country** during 1974-1979 named as “Minicome” as a pilot study to assess the impact of Universal Basic Income on the beneficiaries. The study found an improvement in wages, psychological wellbeing and school and college attendance. Name the country in which “minicome” was launched?

a) Finland b) Sweden c) Canada d) America

(Hints: See the related page, UBI. “Mincome , a basic income experiment in Manitoba that ran from 1974-1979..” Minitoba is a province in Canada).

- 2) Othering involves zeroing in on a difference and using that difference to dismantle a sense of similarity or connectedness between people. Othering sets the stage for discrimination or persecution by reducing empathy and preventing genuine dialogue. Taken to an extreme, othering can result in one group of people denying that another group is even human. The process of “othering” in Nazi Germany led to the persecution and genocide of which of the group listed below:

a) Slavic peoples b) people of Turkish origin c) Muslims d) None of these

- 3) You are working in Finance Ministry of your country. Your finance minister after watching a discussion on TV where the economists argue that country’s economy is likely to enter recession, asks you to verify the fact with the available data/index. Which of the

following indicator will guide you to conclude that the economy is indeed entering/ has entered recession?

- A) Global Hunger Index B) Underwear Index C) Human Development Index

(Hints: Read the Google Search word file uploaded by the IC. “When underwear sales drag, it is an indicator that the economy is dragging.” This is an old and time tested index developed by Alan Greenspan).

- 4) In autocratic governments, the power of the ruler is absolute; dissent is not tolerated. For this reason, scholars have often linked autocracy with totalitarian regimes. However, there are political philosophers who have supported and recommended autocracy as a temporary measure and as a means of restoring political order and ending dissent. One such philosopher who supported autocracy was:

- A) Karl Marx b) Mahatma Gandhi c) Plato d) Niccolo Machiavelli

The countries measuring high in Gross Domestic Product (GDP) also measure high in Human Development Index (HDI) as they have sufficient wealth collected through different taxes which they allocate on enhancing health and education infrastructure within the country thereby improving HDI.

The statement above is:

- A) True B) False

- 5) You are curious to know the salary of one of your friend’s father. You ask: Uncle how much you earn? He is reluctant to reveal his salary. However, after knowing that you are interested to apply Engel’s Coefficient to know his well-being, he reveals the percentage of income he spends on family’s foods; 55% of his income. As per the Engel’s Coefficient he will fall under the category of:

- A) poor, b) barely meeting his daily needs, c) maintaining a well to do standards of living, d) Living a wealthy life.

- 6) The country X scores 3 on the Global Hunger Index (GHI) Survey scale while the country Y scores 98. On the GHI,
- a) The country X has not performed well on GHI while the country Y has done very well on GHI.
 - b) The country X has performed well on GHI while the country Y has done very bad on GHI.
 - c) GHI scale does not use such a score rather it gives later grading ranging from E to A.
 - d) None of the above.

- 7) The UN uses Gini coefficient as an index to measure inequality. It measures inequality from 0 to 1 scale. However, the Gini coefficient does not sufficiently capture very explicitly changes in the top 10% - very rich - or the bottom 40%, where most poverty lies. An alternative, Palma ratio has been developed to measure the inequality. As per the Palma ratio if the richest 10% of the population has five times the income of the bottom 40%, a country's Palma ratio is
- A) 0 b) 3 c) 5 d) 1
- 8) A book titled Cartels, Markets and Crime, the author writes “participants in hard-core cartels agree to insulate themselves from the rigours of a competitive marketplace, substituting cooperation for competition”. Name the author
a) Bruce Wardhaugh, b) Karl Marx, c) Thomas Piketty d) Adam Smith
- 9) The statistics suggest that GDP ranking is directly proportional to GHI ranking. The high GDP ranking countries also rank high on GHI. This statement is:
a) True b) False

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Semester II 2022
Compre Exam (CLOSED BOOK)

Course No: GS F211 Course Title: Modern Political Concepts
Date: 02 June 2022 Time: 2hrs 50 mins Maximum Marks: 30 Weightage: 10

Part II

*Following Questions have been designed to assess the learning outcomes of this course. Please try to limit your answers in 400 words. Please write legibly and avoid unnecessary points not related to the topics. Also try to substantiate your points based on class explanations/discussions. **Please do not opine until you are asked to do so.***

- Q 1)** In a documentary discussed in a class during this course a person puts his optical on the portraits hanged on the wall. He says “He is blue eyed. He is tall. He is slender”
- a) As per your reading of the political concepts which political ideology/concepts he represents to? **(1 mark)**
- b) In what context he makes the above observations and what does he want to convey? **(4 marks)**

Q2) what are the points of difference between the Pluralists and Anarchists over the “origin of the State”? Why do the anarchists do not accept the points offered by the Pluralists about the origin of the State? Please explain. ? **(5 marks)**

Q 3) What do you know about Hitler’s expansionist strategy? Please elaborate on his expansionist plans as explained in the class. **(5 marks)**

(Hint: This question is from PPT: Nationalism part 2, slide 9. You can elaborate on the following part in your words as explained in the class in the context of “expansive nationalism”. Please do not miss any point)

Hitler's writings identified three stage programme of expansionism:

- (i) Greater Germany: Bring all Germans in Austria, Czechoslovakia and Poland in Greater Germany
- (ii) Lebensraum (living space): Creating a German dominated empire stretching into Russia.
- (iii) A world dominated by Aryans. (Could not achieve)

Q 4) A twitter banter between actors Ajay Devgn and Kichcha Sudeep has once again brought the debate to the fore which has been raging since Independence: Hindi as India’s national language. But, what does the Indian Constitution have to say about this? Please elaborate based on your reading. **(5 marks)**

Part C (Text Analysis)

Q 5) Please read the text carefully and answer the following questions

- a) Which school of thought the author represents to? **(1 mark)**

Ans: Marxism/ Communism

(Clue: which Political thought/ Ideology talks about the labour and labour unions?)

- b) Please sum up the essence of the write-up in **TWO sentences**. Your sentence can be longer but should not exceed beyond TWO SENTENCES. If you do so you will not be marked. **(03 marks)**

(The Purpose of this question is to assess your ability to sum up political narrative without omitting key argument)

In his book "Hired: Six Months Undercover in Low-Wage Britain," British journalist James Bloodworth, who once worked undercover at an Amazon warehouse, says the e-commerce giant had peculiar workplace lingo.

For instance, an employee was never "fired," but "released."

There was no distinction between managers and laborers. They were all referred to as "associates," and Bloodworth was taught that warehouse workers were equal to top executives.

The reality, however, was nowhere near what these "nice" expressions suggested. He was sometimes made to walk more than 20 kilometers a day, just to collect items from various parts of the warehouse. Calling in sick resulted in his receiving one disciplinary point, and anyone could be "released" at any time. The euphemisms were obviously meant to whitewash the brutal working conditions. Amazon.Com Inc. has always opposed a labor union.

But finally, a huge airhole has been opened in the United States, Amazon's homeland. A labor union was formed at a New York City warehouse after votes in favor outnumbered those against.

"Now that we can negotiate with management as equals, we believe this trend will expand to other places as well," The Asahi Shimbun recently quoted a jubilant union member as saying.

In the days ahead, the union will be demanding higher wages and longer breaks, the report added. The ripples may eventually spread beyond the United States to the rest of the world.

In this day and age, merchandise, as well as freshly cooked meals, ordered online are delivered with incredible speed. But the convenience may well be in exchange for some people toiling away under the direst of conditions. A system is needed to stop this sort of exploitation, and labor unions can play a crucial role in that.

Q 6) In the text below, the author Aniruddha Ghoshal quotes Rabindra Nath Tagore as saying “ I will not buy glass for the price of diamonds.” In what context Tagore said so? What does Tagore want to convey when he say so? **(4 marks)**

Rabindranath Tagore in 1908: ‘I will never allow patriotism to triumph over humanity as long as I live’

The creator of the national anthem and his views on nationalism, “freedom of mind” and opinions “forcibly made alike”.

Text for Question 6 is below:

Written by [Aniruddha Ghosal](#) |

Updated: December 2, 2016 12:40:29 pm

In 1908, Rabindranath Tagore wrote a letter to his friend, A M Bose, and said, “Patriotism can’t be our final spiritual shelter. I will not buy glass for the price of diamonds and I will never allow patriotism to triumph over humanity as long as I live.” Three years after he wrote this letter — part of Selected Letters of Rabindranath Tagore, published by Cambridge University Press in 1997 — his composition, Jana Gana Mana, was sung for the first time at the Calcutta session of the Congress. Now, 105 years later, as a Supreme Court bench of Justices Dipak Misra and Amitava Roy makes it mandatory for movie halls to play Jana Gana Mana and for people present to stand up as part of their “sacred obligation” to the national anthem, Tagore’s composition has come to symbolise nationalism — something the Nobel laureate was not only critical of, but had famously described as “carnivorous and cannibalistic”.

Recently, Trinamool Congress MP Sugata Bose said in Parliament, “I sometimes fear that those who are defining nationalism so narrowly will end up one day describing Rabindranath Tagore as anti-national if they read some of the sentences in his book on nationalism.”

Watch What Else Is making News

Throughout his life, Tagore remained deeply critical of nationalism, a position that pitted him against Mahatma Gandhi. Tagore argued that when love for one’s country gives way to worship, or becomes a “sacred obligation”, then disaster is the inevitable outcome. “I am willing to serve my country; but my worship I reserve for Right which is far greater than country. To worship my country as a god is to bring curse upon it,” Tagore wrote in his 1916 novel, *The Home and the World*. The words were spoken by Nikhil, one of the two protagonists in the novel, who many thought to be Tagore’s alter-ego.

Further, Tagore argued that disagreement and different notions were of utmost importance. Writing from the Soviet Union in 1937, Tagore reacted positively to the Soviet Experiment, particularly their attempts at eradicating lack of education, but warned of any attempt to curb “freedom of mind”. He wrote, “It would be an uninteresting but a sterile world of mechanical regularity if all our opinions were forcibly made alike... Opinions are constantly changed and rechanged only through free circulation of intellectual forces and persuasion. Violence begets violence and blind stupidity. Freedom of mind is needed for the reception of truth; terror hopelessly kills it.”

From 1877-1917, Tagore’s stance on Swadeshi and the anti-Partition movement of Bengal were one with the political climate. But from 1921, as fractures in society — communal and caste — became apparent, Tagore confessed, “I took a few steps down the road, and then stopped.”

Though Tagore and Mahatma Gandhi shared a philosophical affinity and mutual respect, their disagreement on nationalism would culminate in debates that continue to be relevant. Tagore had warned Gandhi that there remained a thin line that divided nationalism and xenophobia. Tagore and Gandhi had met in July 1921 at his home in Calcutta, where the two had a long and argumentative conversation about what Tagore described as the “bondage of nationalism”.

In the then influential Calcutta journal, *Modern Review*, Tagore wrote about an international desire to “achieve the unity of man by destroying the bondage of nationalism in order to achieve the unity of man”.

India, he argued, didn't have a "real sense" of nationalism and noted that "even though from childhood I had been taught that the idolatry of Nation is almost better than reverence for God and humanity, I believe I have outgrown that teaching, and it is my conviction that my countrymen will gain truly their India by fighting against that education which teaches them that a country is greater than the ideals of humanity."

Tagore's dismay for the fervent nationalism that had gripped India was further shaped by the first World War in 1914. Speaking at Japan after the war, he warned that "the political civilization" that was overrunning the world was "based on exclusiveness" and it is "always watchful to keep at bay the aliens or to exterminate them. It is carnivorous and cannibalistic in its tendencies, it feeds upon the resources of other peoples and tries to swallow their whole future. It is always afraid of other races achieving eminence, naming it as a peril, and tries to thwart all symptoms of greatness outside its own boundaries, forcing down races of men who are weaker, to be eternally fixed in their weakness."

Then again, writing in 1933, when Adolf Hitler had been appointed chancellor of Germany and was rapidly achieving full dictatorial power, Tagore wrote in an essay, *The Changing Age*, later compiled into the book, *Towards Universal Man*: "Germany, in which the light of Europe's Culture was at its brightest, has torn up all civilized values — with what ease has an unspeakable devilry overtaken the entire country."

Even in his lifetime, Tagore's criticism of nationalism didn't make him a popular figure. Gandhi had famously commented, on being criticised by Tagore, that "the poet lives in a magnificent world of his own creation — his world of ideas".

The poet, though, was hardly unaware of the criticism that his ideas opened him up to. Writing to his friend C F Andrews in 1921, from New York, speaking critically of the non-cooperation movement led by Gandhi in India, he admitted to being "afraid" that he would "be rejected by my own people when I go back to India. My solitary cell is awaiting me in my Motherland. In their present state of mind, my countrymen will have no patience with me, who believe God to be higher than my own country".

He added, "I know such spiritual faith may not lead us to political success; but I say to myself as India had ever said, 'Even then – what?'" The letter was published by S Ganesan in 1924 as part

of Tagore's Letters from Abroad and was quoted by historian Ramchandra Guha in his 2009 introduction to Tagore's Nationalism.

Q7) During this course we also discussed that we can decipher the political ideology of the individuals based on the terminology he uses. Please carefully read the text below and identify the ideology/school of thoughts he represents to? **(2 marks)**

Lament of a Small Man

Subhash C. Sharma May 30, 2022

Dear citizen,

In this unimaginably vast cosmos, brahmaand as we call it, our planet is a tiny speck of rock and metal – as astronomer Carl Sagan famously said – “where we are like butterflies who flutter for a day and think it is forever”. What then is the significance of a hubris-intoxicated nothing-me, and my idle fulminations?

Putting politics and our individual persuasions and biases aside, speaking heart-to-heart, I have been most deeply disturbed by the current rash of demolitions, the mounting levels of Hindu-Muslim poison in the air and vicious hatred-mongering clogging the social media. Whither is my beloved Bharat turning, I ask myself.

At times, it gives a frightening sense of déjà vu of the pre-Partition/Partition days. But then the dialectic was different. It served the masters of our enslaved nation best. They played their divide-and-rule policy to the hilt to perpetuate their rule, nursing a vile smirk as we rioted and killed one another. But that such sinister monster of communal divide should rear its ugly head and walk the streets inflamed by hate speeches, aggressive processions and abusive slogans makes me shudder with horror.

Surely, our political leaders of all hues can conjure up better agendas to win votes: ‘green’ agendas that promote goodwill, harmony, love, peace. A squabbling, rioting nation can only reverse towards medievalism and never march forwards – only to become an object of ridicule and derision in the world.

I am personally more carnal than religious and therefore lay no claim to any scholarship in matters religious. But to me, any religion is a path to salvation. Our own speaks of piety, cultivating peace of mind, enlightenment, detachment from materialistic pursuits, meditation and moksha. A religious procession – by the Hindus, Muslims, Christians or Sikhs – should indeed be a sight to behold. It can be festive, colourful, merry and joyous but such that evokes deep feelings of adulation among all – including the non-conformists like me.

Please dear citizen, tell me honestly, no malice, no aspersion intended, is it fair and proper or in any way ennobling to take out a procession brandishing swords, guns and lathis, and fouling the air with incendiary slogans? Deliberately stopping at others' places of worship? I, for one, a Hindu, would only diminish myself and bring shame on my grand religion by shouting rape threats. Such uncouth shouts provoke nothing but retaliation, triggering a horrifying chain reaction.

As I write this, my mind at once goes to the Sikh processions we all see in our towns. What a riot of yellow-blue, how eye-catching, how enchanting the spectacle is! Likewise, what a visual delight are the jhankis during our Holi festival in my own town of Palampur. People descend from remote villages and vie with each other to behold the bewitching sight of volunteers imaginatively done up as deities depicting some mythological story.

I wish my great nation – so beautiful, so fragrantly diverse – reverts to this festive spirit of celebration and once again becomes the envy of the world, the jewel that it was and still can be – a shining light of multiculturalism, inclusivity, peace, love, goodwill; with citizens sharing each other's smiles and tears, striving for a nobler, higher goal; a country led by sagacious politician-statesmen fired by the glorious tradition of "sarve bhavntu sukhinah..."; a country made of Gurudev Rabindranath's, Gandhiji's dreams...